International Teacher Education

Reflection Mini Lesson

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Classcode	ITSB23V1MPES1-A
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Assessment date	2/11/2026

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1. Introduction & Overall Impression

Teaching my mini lesson on the Egg Theory was a humbling experience, but looking back, it is also one of the most valuable learning moments I have had so far. If I am entirely honest, in my own opinion, it felt like it went pretty badly. I found myself underprepared, caught off guard by timing, and lacking the safety net of my notes because I didn't enable Presenter View in PowerPoint. This forced me into a lot more improvisation than I was comfortable with.

However, despite the rocky delivery, I really like that I went through this. It highlights exactly what I need to work on as I grow into my role as an educator. Teaching is a craft, and this session provided a clear roadmap of actionable areas for growth.

2. What Went Well

- **Confident Body Language (Perceived vs. Actual):** Surprisingly, a piece of feedback I received noted that my body language looked confident. Even though I felt the exact opposite inside, projecting an outward appearance of calm is a positive starting point.
- **Willingness to Learn:** The best takeaway from this lesson is my own mindset afterward. Instead of getting discouraged, I have a clear, honest assessment of my weak points and a strong motivation to improve.

3. What Could Be Improved & How

- **Preparation and Pacing (Time Management):**
    - *The Issue:* The lesson ran short (6 minutes instead of the required 10), and even if I had explained the Egg Theory in full detail, I still would have had time to spare.

    - *The Fix:* Proper lesson planning and pacing are non-negotiable. I cannot rely on talking my way through a gap. Moving forward, I need to build in interactive learning activities, check for understanding, or student-centered tasks to naturally anchor the timing and engage the room.

- **Technical Setup (Presenter View):**
    - *The Issue:* Forgetting to turn on PowerPoint presentation notes left me stranded without my prompt structure, forcing me to improvise on the spot.

    - *The Fix:* Always double-check technical settings before stepping in front of the class. A simple pre-flight checklist will ensure notes, audio, and slides are configured correctly every single time.

- **Voice Projection and Language Comfort:**
    - *The Issue:* I noticed (and received feedback) that I mumbled and did not speak loudly enough. A major factor here is that I am still building confidence in my English-speaking skills.

    - *The Fix:* Consciously working on projection, slowing down my articulation, and leaning into practice will build fluency and vocal presence over time.

- **Hand Gestures and Physical Expression:**
    - *The Issue:* One piece of feedback pointed out a desire for more hand movement. Reflecting on this, I realize I tend to keep my hands still when talking.

    - *The Fix:* Purposeful hand gestures help emphasize key points, regulate pacing, and project energy. I will actively practice incorporating natural hand
    - movements into my delivery during rehearsals.

4. Actionable Improvements If I Had to Teach This Lesson Again

If I were handed the opportunity to re-teach this exact mini lesson on the Egg Theory tomorrow, I would implement these changes immediately:

1. **Rethink the Structure with Activities:** Instead of relying solely on direct instruction, I would break the theory down into a two-part mini-inquiry: a 3-minute hook/explanation, a 4-minute pair-and-share or analysis activity where students interact with the core concept, and a 3-minute debrief.
2. **Lock Down the Tech:** Ensure Presenter View is active, so my structural cues, transitions, and timing reminders are right in front of me.
3. **Intentional Physicality:** Plan out two or three moments where I move across the floor or use deliberate hand gestures to signal a transition in the historical or conceptual narrative.
4. **Vocal Warm-Up & Projection:** Consciously stand tall, project to the back of the room from the very first sentence and speak with deliberate articulation rather than rushing through sentences.

Feedback given to me

To: Dylan Schlepers
From: La Mor
Alexandra Powell
Date: 5-10-2026
Subject: The egg theory

What did you learn?
- I was introduced to a branch of philosophy I was unaware of.
-I learnt that some people think we are all the same person and all the same things.
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Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)		x	x		Unfortunately i found that I couldn't hear you clearly when you were speaking because the loudness of your voice was on the lower end. I would say try speak louder and clearer.
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)			x	x	I think your body language was confident the way you held yourself and looked at the class with no meekness was very good.
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)			X x		

Engagement (to the classroom)		x	x		
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?			xx		

Feedback:

You have a nice manner when teaching. A quiet and firm confidence.

I would have liked to know more about the author of the idea/short story.

I think we could have been pressed harder to try to explain our understanding in our own words, and also the potential value of the construct as a world view.

You stumbled at points, so perhaps you can think about rehearsing more - what you'll say as attached to your main talking points in a bit more detail. And think about what can support you in that as you present.

You choose a complex concept to teach, so took a brave risk I think.

I think you have a confidence about you when you teach that is stable. But I would have liked if you spoke up louder and maybe explained more about who believes in this theory and where it came from. Also it seemed you were a bit under time so maybe add another activity or more content to your presentation.

To: Dylan Schlepers From: Rikst Bijlsma Date: October 5th Subject: The Egg theory

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)			X		I could understand you most of the time but sometimes you were mumbling a bit and I couldn't quite hear you properly.
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)			X		You were turned to us most of the time which was good, but you didn't really move your hands around a lot

					which made me vulnerable for distractions
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)			X		I understood most of it but since it was a difficult and confusing subject I was left confused every now and then

Engagement (to the classroom)		X			I would recommend putting in an acitivity to make it longer and more activie

Has the goal of the lesson been reached?			x		I think so

Feedback:

You chose a difficult subject so that made it tricky. I would recommend throwing in an activity in there and move around a little more. Loosen up a little. I did like your subject but since it was more complicated it made it hard to understand. Maybe choose an easier idea or reading into the subject a little more. However, you did pretty good despite it being a difficult subject

To: Dylan Schlepers
From: Yulin Visser
Date: 05-10-2026
Subject: The egg theory

What did you learn?
- The existence of the egg theory, as well as the basic principles
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Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)			x		I felt like you sometimes had a little trouble finding the right words, but overall you did good.
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				x	You had a very calm and collected presence. You could've been a bit more expressive, but maybe that just doesn't fit your teaching style (and that's okay!)
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)			x		The information you gave us was clear, but a little scarce.
Engagement (to the classroom)			x		You did ask us some questions, but the lesson overall could've been more interactive.

Has the goal of the lesson been reached?			x		I definitely learnt something, but I think it could've been even more :)

Feedback:

It's a shame you had some technical issues, because I felt like you did know more about the theory. You chose a very interesting topic which caught the attention of everyone from the very beginning.

Next time you could give us a little more information. Besides, as it is a philosophical theory, it would've been nice to create an environment in which we could share our own view on it and our ideas. Maybe even let us think of and explain whether it's a valid theory and what critiques we could think of. A debate would've been really fun! And for you, as the teacher, it would've been interesting to think of ways to ensure all students feel safe participating.

I definitely think you had a successful first teaching experience!

To: Brittney York

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 5 October 2026

Subject: Discovering Aruba

What did you learn?

- Geography around Aruba

- Life on Aruba

- Popular dishes from Aruba

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Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)				X	Was good
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				X	nice
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				X	It was very clear

Engagement (to the classroom)				x	You did not lose my attention
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				X	Yes

To: Kaia Turner

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 5-10-2026

Subject: History

What did you learn? - What are goat riders - The origins of goat riders - Why they made up goat riders - The actual history surrounding it

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)				X	It was good to follow and nice to listen to.

Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				X	Where possible you used nonverbal communication v. Also the vibe you created with nonverbal communication, was very pleasent.
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				x	The lesson was quit understandable
Engagement (to the classroom)				x	Engaging due to the way it was presented
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				x	yes

Feedback:

Your lesson was very informative and pleasant to listen to. You said that you wanted to carry out the vibe of story telling, although as you mentioned yourself that was not always the case, some parts I actually saw you loosen up a bit and then you were carrying out this vibe. So good job.

To: Liam Potgieter

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 5 October 2026

Subject: Drumming 101

What did you learn? - the essence of drumming - - -

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)			X		It was good to follow and we could hear you quite well, however I think I missed a bit of enthusiasm or differentiating in your tone,

					otherwise it was excellent.
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				X	You held eye contact with the class, and used other types of nonverbal communication.
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				X	The lesson was understandable and good to follow
Engagement (to the classroom)				X	To engage everyone in the room with making a little song, and one drumming with your tools was a excellent way to show us the foundation of drumming.
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				X	yes

Feedback:

I really like your lesson, it was easy to follow and to understand. How you implemented the of us trying to make a beat was an excellent way to show us the foundation of drumming. If I have to give one point of critic I would say that I missed a bit of tone differentiation, otherwise your lesson was quite good.

To: Mats van den berg

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 5th of October 2026

Subject: Syncope

What did you learn?

- The signs of when you are about to faint.

- how to prevent fainting

- What is happening when you fainting

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)			X		You used a very engaging voice it was easy to follow the whole time. I did not get distracted or anything. I just think that the tone of voice could be a bit different. I get

					that it is a serious topic, but especially if you teach to a younger group of students I would recommend a voice is not a bit terrifying to listen too.
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)			X		The same as the previous, your hand gestures and eye contact supported what and how you were teaching, only sometimes it looked like you pierced through our skulls and wanted to look at our souls. Maybe it could be a little less terifying.
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				x	It was very clear due to the repetition.
Engagement (to the classroom)				x	It was very engaging due to the activity
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				x	Yes, loud and clear

Feedback:

As previous mentioned the lesson was very engaging and understandable. I liked the activity you put in to give us a better understanding the how. But if I have to give a point of critic it has to be that your tone and how you looked at us sometimes, could be a bit terrifying for actual student. It it fine for us but if you would have teach this to a younger audience it is good to keep in mind.

But well done!

To: Rikst
From: Dylan
Date: 7-10-2026
Subject: Schotland

What did you learn?

- Language they used in old Schotland

- National animal of schotland is a uncirorn

- Loch ness is in Schotland

- Things about the highlands of Schotland

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)			The communication was most of the time perfect but I can remember a bit of rattling sometime where it was hard to stay		

			attentioned. You could heard the enthusiasm, however I would advise I guess to sometimes take a breather and slow down a bit.		
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				There was most of the time eye contact with the whole class and you used hand gestures to interact with the board.	
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				The lesson was clear, what you wanted us to know I think everything was well received	
Engagement (to the classroom)			I think the engagemend was held most of the time.		

Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				yes	

Feedback:

I really liked the subject you chose. It is something that really suits you and you know a lot of. You also are really enthusiastic about it. And that something that is usefull if you want to carry information over. But do not let that get in the way of how you speak. Do not get me wrong it was not bad, but if I have to mention something it is that it was sometimes hard to hold the attention because you often speak to fast and too enthusiastic.

To: Tara Voicu

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 5-10-2026

Subject: One direction

What did you learn?

- members of one direction

- How it disbanded

Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)				X	You spoke clearly and understandable
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				X	Also the vibe you carried with nonverbal communication really showed how enthusiastic you are about the subject and really helped delivering it
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				X	good

Engagement (to the classroom)				X	You really held the attention with your enthusiasm and how the information was delivered, did not let us drift of.
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				.	yes

Feedback:

I really liked your enthusiasm and that really showed you picked the right topic. Your delivering was really good. Also the way you chose to know if we know if we understand with a kahoot was a nice touch.

To: Yulin visser

From: Dylan Schlepers

Date: 8-10-2026

Subject: plant communciation

What did you learn?

- How plants communicate

- How they act when being threaten

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Criteria	**Acceptable with significant shortcomings**	**Acceptable**	**Good**	**Excellent**	**Why did you choose this grade?**
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)				x	It was good to follow and everything was clear
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				X	good
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				X	good
Engagement (to the classroom)				X	Your hook was actually quit nice and engaging. This

					way you had our attention right from the start, and you held it the whole lesson
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				X	yes

Feedback:

The way you have made the hook really grabbed our attention, and you held it your whole lesson. The lesson was informative, but not boring, actually quite interesting and fun.

Feedback form

From: Dylan Schlepers

To: Alexandra Powell

Criteria	Acceptable with significant shortcomings	Acceptable	Good	Excellent	Why did you choose this grade?
Verbal communication (instructions, tone of voice etc.)				x	You spoke clearly and understandable, and how you use intonation was pleasent to follow.x\
Nonverbal communication (eye contact, gestures)				x	You held eye contact well, and used gestures to support your information
Clarity (how understandable is the lesson?)				x	yeah it was very clear
Engagement (to the classroom)				x	The lesson was very engaging. You delivered the information you wanted, and still had room for a few games. Using hangman as hook really got our attention right from the start. I really liked that. And how you also used our own opinions by moving through te classroom and telling our opinions, was a good way to let us implement the concept our self.
Has the goal of the lesson been reached?				x	yes

Feedback:

I really liked your hook and games you have implemented in your lesson. It is a good way to really engage us.

5: Reflection on Attended Mini-Lessons

Observing my peers teach provided very helpful perspective on classroom management, pacing, and engagement strategies:

- **Brittney (Discovering Aruba) & Tara (One Direction):** Both delivered their lessons with high energy and genuine enthusiasm. Seeing how their excitement naturally held the room's attention showed me how much physical energy and vocal variation can drive engagement.
- **Kaia (Goat Riders), Yulin (Plant Communication) & Alexandra (Procrastination):** They all used great hooks and created a comfortable, welcoming vibe. Yulin's opening hook grabbed attention immediately, which highlighted me how important the first 30 seconds of a lesson are for setting the tone.
- **Liam (Drumming 101) & Mats (Syncope):** Liam's use of a hands-on activity (having us build a beat) was a great example of student-centered learning. Mats used strong repetition and clear vocal projection, though observing him reminded me of the

importance of balancing authority with an approachable tone when teaching younger audiences.

- **Rikst (Scotland):** Rikst's passion for her subject was obvious, but her quick pace showed me how easily enthusiasm can cause a teacher to rush. It reinforced that taking deliberate breathers helps keep the audience on track.

Key Takeaway for My Own Practice: The most effective lessons weren't necessarily the ones with the most slides, but the ones where the teacher used interactive activities, clear vocal projection, and purposeful body language. Watching my peers confirmed that adding an activity and using more hand gestures will immediately improve my own teaching delivery.